AI CITATIONS

“YouTube is the most-cited site in AI search.” It depends on the engine.

The headline is an average. Your buyers do not use the average.

GOOGLE AI OVERVIEWS

22.5%

of answers cite YouTube

CHATGPT

0.9%

of answers cite YouTube

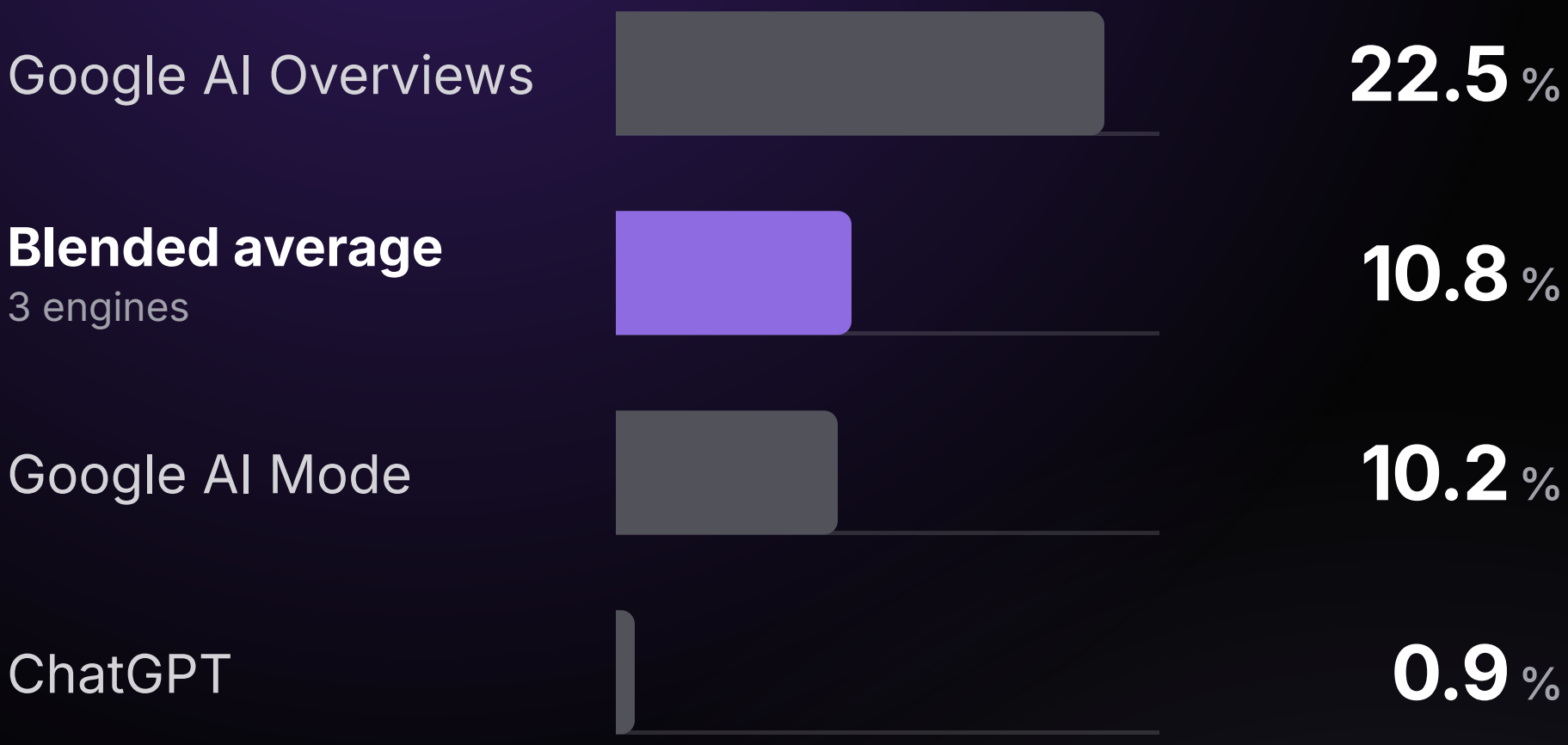
The blended 10.8% matches neither of these two engines.

RankSpot AI Citation Index, 129,537 answers, 1 Sep to 10 Nov 2026 (vendor data).

ONE INDEX

One average, three realities

Share of answers that cite youtube.com.



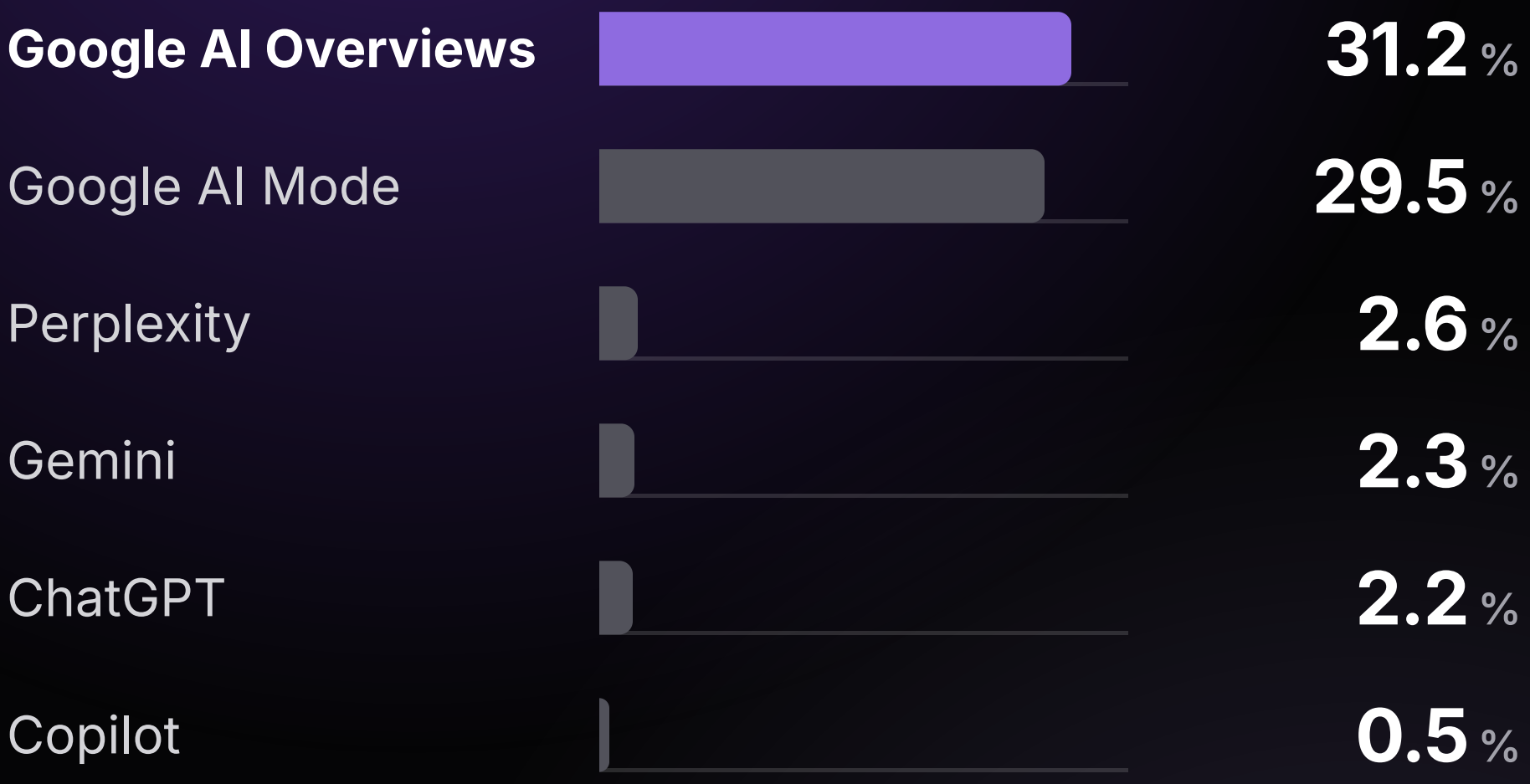
Two of the three engines in the blend are Google’s. The prompts are buying questions from RankSpot’s customers, not a random sample.

RankSpot AI Citation Index, 129,537 answers, 1 Sep to 10 Nov 2026. Share of answers citing the domain at least once.

A SECOND VENDOR

Six engines, same shape

Share of each engine’s answers that cite YouTube.



Different questions and window than slide 2, so compare the shape, not the numbers.

Searchable, 29 Aug to 27 Sep 2026, answers that cited at least one source, on questions its customers track.

SOURCE DIET

Every engine has its own diet

The social site each engine cites most. AI Overviews and AI Mode are Google’s.

ENGINE	TOP SOCIAL SITE	% OF ANSWERS
ChatGPT	**Reddit**	5.9%
Perplexity	**Reddit**	11.3%
AI Overviews	**YouTube**	31.2%
AI Mode	**YouTube**	29.5%
Gemini	**Reddit**	5.4%
Copilot	**LinkedIn**	1.5%

Searchable, 29 Aug to 27 Sep 2026. Perplexity: LinkedIn is close, 10.9%.

Read the mix behind the number

VENDOR DATA

Both studies come from AI visibility vendors, on questions their own customers track. They show what engines cited, not market share.

THE AVERAGE MOVES

Add more Google engines to the blend and YouTube rises. Add more chatbots and it falls.

THE QUESTIONS MATTER

On buying questions, Wikipedia ranks 72nd and shows up in 0.7% of ChatGPT answers. Ask what something is and the ranking changes.

That last ranking is from RankSpot’s own methodology page.

RankSpot, 10 Nov 2026. Searchable, 29 Sep 2026.

WHAT I WOULD DO

This week, three steps

Which engine do your buyers actually ask?

1

Find the engine your buyers use

Add “ChatGPT, Google AI or another AI” to “how did you find us?”

2

Measure each engine on its own

Run your 10 buyer questions in each one and write down who is cited.

3

Then choose the lever

Google AI: one B2B study found cited videos have buying-question titles and timestamps. ChatGPT: YouTube is in 1 to 2% of answers here, so study who it does cite.

Sources: RankSpot, Searchable and Foundation Inc. Links in the first comment.